

SEA Ventures

Vietnam & Thailand playbook on a live 6-product stack

Master Business Plan

July 2026 · Operating entity: licensed Vietnamese company (SaaS)



01

Thesis & Why Now

Southeast Asia's front office is digitized — QR payments reach street stalls, Zalo/LINE reach ~80% of their populations, e-commerce GMV grows double-digit (\$39B Vietnam, \$56B Thailand in 2025). The back office is not. Meanwhile Vietnam has created a regulatory forcing function (khoán abolition + e-invoice mandate) that pushes 5.2M micro-businesses into bookkeeping in a single year. We enter with three unfair advantages: (1) a licensed Vietnamese company already able to sell SaaS locally; (2) a proven AI stack — six live products whose engines (email triage, receipt extraction, carrier routing, registry+map, compliance-by-code) port directly; (3) founder presence between HCMC and the Gulf.

02

The Asset Base (all live)

Product	Engine it contributes	URL
Sổ Sạch	receipt→ledger→tax pipeline, Zalo bot	so-sach.onrender.com
NINE2FIVE	email triage, carry-forward, drafts; MoR checkout	jarvis-app-pzfc.onrender.com
Grapes	story-first marketplace, discovery map, registry	grapes-pxsm.onrender.com
Bottega	carrier-routing engine by zone/cold-chain	bottega-zah4.onrender.com
Chiavi / Stanza	compliance-by-code playbook	chiavi.onrender.com

03

The Portfolio of Plays

Play	Market	Price	Status	Y3 ARR
1 · Sổ Sạch — AI bookkeeper (LEAD)	VN · 5.2M hộ	69–149k VND/mo	LIVE + BP	\$1.6M
2 · NINE2FIVE Expats	HCMC 200k+ / BKK 250-300k expats	\$10–15/mo	LIVE (checkout ready)	\$0.5M
3 · Innkeeper — guesthouse copilot	TH boutique hotels/tour ops	THB 990–1,990/mo	spec (port of #2)	\$0.6M
4 · Routing engine B2B license	VN D2C brands (GHTK/GHN/Viettel)	1.5M VND/mo	engine live (Bottega)	\$0.3M
5 · Làng Nghề / OTOP Direct	VN craft villages · TH OTOP	8–12% take	LATER — file MoIT early	\$0 (Y4+)

Traps we will not walk into: consumer marketplaces against Shopee/TikTok Shop (97% of VN GMV), food delivery (25–30% commissions, subsidy war), street-food POS in Thailand (LINE MAN Wongnai: 500k of 700k restaurants), and direct ports of Italian legal constructs (Chiavi/Stanza products).

04

Play-by-Play

1 · Sổ Sạch (VN) — LEAD

Full plan in the dedicated document (SoSach_Business_Plan). Wedge: 100-household pilot via 3–5 tax agents in HCMC; \$300k ask; Y3 \$1.6M ARR at >85% margin. Riskiest assumption: households pay anything rather than lean on a relative — tested with 200 QR flyers for <\$500.

2 · NINE2FIVE — HCMC/Bangkok internationals

- Who: founders, agency directors, consultants, senior expats — Gmail-native, card-paying. CAC near zero via chambers (EuroCham/BritCham), coworking (Dreamplex, True Digital Park), founder communities.
- 90 days: 20 design partners from own network → 'Vietnam/Thailand layer' (visa & TRC deadlines, local-holiday awareness in the brief) → 150 paying. Checkout already shipped (MoR).
- Riskiest assumption: strangers connect Gmail read-only to a new brand → \$200 ad test measuring OAuth completion, not clicks.

3 · Innkeeper — Thailand guesthouse/tour-operator copilot

- What: the NINE2FIVE engine pointed at a property's Gmail + LINE OA: OTA emails parsed into a unified calendar, guest replies drafted EN/TH, a daily owner brief. PMS vendors ignore LINE; this rides it.
- Wedge & entity: 10 Chiang Mai guesthouses via hotelier groups; THB 990–1,990/mo; sold cross-border from the VN entity — Thai VES registration only above THB 1.8M B2C/yr; PDPA local representative appointed at scale.
- 90 days: LINE-connected pilot, charge from day one; the OTA-parser reuses Sổ Sạch's extraction pipeline.

4 · Carrier-routing engine — B2B license (VN)

- What: Bottega's routing engine mapped to GHTK/GHN/Viettel Post/J&T: white-label routing + story-first storefront for specialty D2C brands (coffee, Đà Lạt produce). Never run the marketplace — license the picks.
- Proof for <\$500: re-price one roaster's last 100 shipments across couriers; show the % saved. 90 days: courier API map + 3 design-partner roasters + a 'which courier wins per province' lead-gen report.

5 · Làng Nghề / OTOP Direct — the patient play

Grapes/Bottega playbook on craft villages (17,068 OCOP products, 9,195 makers) and Thai OTOP: story-first, direct-from-maker, routing-powered. Gated by Vietnam's MoIT platform registration (Decree 52/85 — months) and Thailand's ETDA/DPS notification — start filings early, launch as a curated catalog (not a platform) to stay under thresholds while validating demand. No UGC features anywhere (Decree 147 licensing trap).

05

Sequencing & Consolidated Numbers

Quarter	Milestones
Q3 2026	Sổ Sạch pilot (100 hộ) · NINE2FIVE founding 100 via MoR · flyer & OAuth tests
Q4 2026	Sổ Sạch agent dashboard · Innkeeper pilot (10 guesthouses) · routing re-pricing proof
2027	Sổ Sạch 2k subs · NINE2FIVE 1k · Innkeeper 150 properties · 3 routing licensees · MoIT filed

Quarter	Milestones
2028–29	Provinces + agent network · OTOP/Làng Nghề launch if filings cleared · consolidated ~\$3M ARR

	Y1 (2027)	Y2 (2028)	Y3 (2029)
Consolidated ARR	\$0.25M	\$1.1M	\$3.0M
Gross margin	82%	85%	86%
EBITDA	–\$180k	+\$90k	+\$900k
Headcount	4	9	18

Sum of play-level projections with 20% haircut for focus cost. Illustrative, not a guarantee.

06

Entity & Regulatory Map

Topic	Position
VN — selling SaaS	Local licensed company sells with 10% VAT + own e-invoices. Clean.
VN — marketplace	MoIT registration (Decree 52/85) required for third-party platforms — months of lead time.
VN — UGC	Decree 147/2024: social features trigger licensing at 10k visits/mo — keep products transactional.
TH — cross-border SaaS	Legal & lightweight: VES registration + 7% VAT only above THB 1.8M/yr B2C; B2B reverse-charged (15% WHT watch).
TH — local ops	FBA caps foreign ownership at 49% (services) unless BOI-promoted; PDPA local representative; ETDA/DPS for platforms.

07

Risks & Kill Criteria

- Willingness-to-pay (Số Sạch): week-4 retention <25% or agents refuse 30% share → pivot to agent-only tooling.
- Trust barrier (NINE2FIVE): OAuth completion <15% on warm traffic → double down on in-person/community onboarding, drop paid ads.
- Regulatory drift: thresholds and rates are env-configurable in code; quarterly legal review budgeted in every plan.
- Founder bandwidth: the sequencing above is serial by design — one launch per quarter, kill or scale before the next.

Contact
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All six referenced products are live and demoable today. Market figures per cited 2024–26 sources (e-Conomy SEA, national press, official regulations); projections illustrative.